How to install Python (for hidemydoppler)

> **Shortcut:** on Windows, just double-click **Prepare System.cmd** in the hidemydoppler folder and click **Prepare system**. It installs Python and everything else for you. On Linux, run `./prepare_linux.sh`. The manual steps below are for when that doesn't work.

hidemydoppler needs **Python 3.9 or newer**. Get the newest 3.x release you can. Pick your system below, then jump to **Verify** and **Run hidemydoppler**.

Windows 10 / 11

Option A: installer (easiest) 1. Go to https://www.python.org/downloads/ and click the big **Download Python 3.x** button. 2. Run the installer. On the first screen, **tick "Add python.exe to PATH"** at the bottom. This is the step most people miss. 3. Click **Install Now**. When it finishes, click **Disable path length limit** if it's offered.

Option B: winget (one command) Open **Terminal** or **PowerShell** and run:

```
winget search Python.Python
winget install -e --id Python.Python.3.13
```

Swap `3.13` for the newest version the search shows.

> Already have Python but `python` opens the Microsoft Store? Go to **Settings > Apps > Advanced app settings > App execution aliases** and turn off the two "App Installer python" entries, then open a new terminal.

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macOS

Option A: installer: download the macOS installer from https://www.python.org/downloads/, run it, then double-click **Install Certificates.command** in the Python folder under Applications.

Option B: Homebrew:

```
brew install python
```

On macOS, the command is usually `python3` (not `python`).

Linux

Ubuntu / Debian

```
sudo apt update
sudo apt install -y python3 python3-pip python3-venv
```

RHEL / Rocky / Alma / CentOS Stream / Fedora

```
sudo dnf install -y python3 python3-pip
```

Arch

```
sudo pacman -S python python-pip
```

On Linux, the command is `python3`.

Verify

Open a **new** terminal window (so it picks up the new PATH) and run:

```
python --version       # Windows
```

```
python3 --version       # macOS / Linux
```

You should see `Python 3.9` or higher. On Windows, `py --version` also works.

Run hidemydoppler

1. Unzip or copy the `hidemydoppler` folder somewhere handy.
2. Open a terminal **in that folder**. - Windows: open the folder in File Explorer, click the address bar, type `cmd`, press Enter. - macOS / Linux: `cd` to the folder.
3. Start the UI: `python ui.py # Windows python3 ui.py # macOS / Linux`
4. Your browser opens the hidemydoppler page. Click **Run prep check**. If anything is missing (numpy, scipy, ffmpeg), click **Install missing** and approve any admin or password prompt that pops up.

Prefer the command line? Run `python setup_check.py` instead. It does the same check and asks before installing anything.

Common snags

Problem	Fix
`python` is not recognized	Python isn't on PATH. Re-run the installer, choose **Modify**, and tick **Add Python to environment variables**. Or use `py` instead.
`pip` says "externally managed environment" (Linux)	Make a virtual environment: `python3 -m venv .venv`, then `source .venv/bin/activate`, then rerun.
ffmpeg installed but still "missing"	Close and reopen the terminal (or restart `ui.py`) so the new PATH loads.
Browser doesn't open	Go to http://127.0.0.1:8765 yourself.
Port already in use	`python ui.py --port 8800`